

industries over the last 15 years. Today, in every sector – media, scientific projects, telecom, IT, retail, banking, etc – the extent to which open source is used, is increasing. From developing new products using FOSS and implementing enterprise solutions, to integrating open source modules with existing commercial blocks – there are a whole gamut of opportunities for FOSS and Linux experts,” says Deepak Gupta, associate vice president, technology, GlobalLogic, which has about 60-65 per cent of its 2,800 to 3,000 global workforce working on FOSS technologies.

Embedded Linux experts

There is an increasing demand for FOSS/Linux experts in the embedded market. While the growing popularity of the Android and Ubuntu operating systems for netbooks and nettops has resulted in consumers choosing FOSS/Linux in embedded devices, the arrival of 32-bit microcontrollers has made embedded players even happier with open source. “There is a huge demand for programmers who can do the basic porting on the Android platform and build Android-based applications. As per surveys, the share of Android in the Linux mobile market is expected to grow by 33 per cent by 2015. Alongside, in the netbook and nettop market, Ubuntu is emerging as an easy to use platform for personal computing. Industrial sectors, too, are driving the demand for Linux in the embedded space as most non-GUI devices are moving towards open source and Linux. A majority of the microcontroller based industrial device systems that used 8- and 16-bit microcontrollers, now want to move to a Linux operating system to use the TCP/IP stack, GPRS, Wi-Fi capability, etc. Further, with the industry moving towards 32-bit microcontrollers, which don’t need high-end GUIs and are not too interactive, the doors to Linux have automatically been opened,” says Maharajan Veerabahu, project manager, e-con Systems India, a firm that set up an open source R&D team in 2004.

Start-ups now ready to embrace open source developers

A large number of technology and consumer electronics start-ups are also flocking to open source, resulting in a demand for professionals well versed with FOSS skillsets.



Open source team @ GlobalLogic

“Close to 90 per cent of technology oriented start-ups use open source because it has made technology more accessible to them, enabling them to innovate with little challenge. Open source allows start-ups like ours to pick up ready made components, and then focus on building a user experience around them. If we use an analogy from the automobile industry, what open source gives you is the engine and chassis of the car allowing you to focus solely on the other features you want to add. This makes innovation easier and brings down the cost associated with it. Such a movement has resulted in an increasing demand for developers ready to work on FOSS/Linux from technology start-ups,” says Vishal Borker, CEO and technical director, NextBIT Computing, a consumer electronics start-up.

FOSS professionals – keeping the heart of enterprise computing alive

Further, open source is fast becoming the heart of enterprise computing. Customer relation management (CRM), content management system (CMS), e-commerce, and enterprise resource planning (ERP) are enterprise applications driving the FOSS demand, resulting in an increasing thirst for FOSS/Linux experts among enterprises. “Open source and Linux



“Web 2.0 technologies are also driving demand for FOSS/Linux experts as more than 50 per cent of Web 2.0 solutions built today are coming from open source tools.”

Gokul Muralidharan, open source expert, Aspire Systems